

Fakes That Hurt



BIG IDEA A fake image can cause real harm. Making or sharing one is abuse, and it is never a joke. The target is never at fault. Bystanders can STOP the spread, SUPPORT, TELL, and REPORT.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

COUNSELOR HEADS-UP FIRST + OPT-OUT PLAN Pre-notice and opt-out slip out 5 school days ahead (Appendix A). Counselor checklist done (Appendix B), counselor on call that day and the next. Alternate R8-ALT and a supervising adult ready. Teach mid-week, two days after Lesson 7.

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: Workbook CF-8; R8 Bystander Cards (Cam, Ari, Idris) and Move Cards per group; Reporting Quick Card per student; Pass and Step-Out cards.

- ☐ Opt-out students and the R8-ALT space are arranged.
- ☐ Know your harassment, Title IX and reporting policy.
- ☐ Show no image. Name no fake-making app.

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* Hackles up? If something about an image or rumor feels wrong, trust that. It is never the fault of the person it targets. "Today is about fake pictures. Some apps and AI tools can make a convincing fake of a real person in seconds, and some are used to hurt people. The pictures are fake. The harm is real. No images and no graphic details today, and your Pass card and the Quiet Corner are open at any time. If someone makes a fake picture of you, it is never your fault. Today we study the bystanders. Some choices spread harm. Some stop it."

FUN BOOST Four Corners (calm; no scoring). Post STOP, SUPPORT, TELL, REPORT. Students walk silently to the move they would find hardest and talk there about what would help.

LEVEL-UP Upstander Card. Make a one-page card for a younger student with the four moves in plain words.

DIFFERENTIATE Offer sentence starters for private messages and one bystander card per group.

FAMILY CARD Say: "If you see a fake picture of someone, do not share it. Tell me. If a fake of you appears, tell me. You will not be in trouble."

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN *The Upstander Four*

- 1 (1 min) Read CF-8.** Someone alters Nia's school photo into a fake that looks private and humiliating, and it lands in a class chat. Cam laughs and forwards it. Ari freezes. Idris feels sick and does not know how to help.
- 2 (1 min) Real or fake, the harm is the same.** Making or sharing one can bring serious consequences at school and under law.
- 3 (4 min) The Upstander Four,** each group with a Bystander Card. **STOP the spread** (no opening, forwarding, liking or screenshots). **SUPPORT** privately: "I am sorry this happened. It is not your fault. I am here." **TELL** an adult. **REPORT** in the app and through an adult. Write a private line to Nia, a line to the chat ("Not okay. I am not sharing this and I am reporting it."), and one adult to tell.
- 4 (2 min) If it is you, or you shared one.** STOP, SAVE words and links (never the picture), TELL, REPORT; Take It Down helps remove images of anyone under 18. If you forwarded one, it is not too late: stop, tell a trusted adult.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** "Why does a fake picture hurt even though it is not real?"
- 2** "Why is 'it was just a joke' no excuse?"
- 3** "Why might reporting feel hard? How could a friend help?" (Offer to go with them.)

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN "Pause: do not spread. Check: is this hurting someone? Tell an adult. STOP the spread, SUPPORT, TELL, REPORT. It is never your fault if a fake picture of you exists. The person who made or shared it is responsible."

Hand signal: Hackles Up (hand brushed up the neck, optional), then Pause, Check, Tell. Post it: "Do not pass it on. Go to the person, then go to an adult."

EXIT TICKET "Write one sentence you could send privately to a classmate targeted by a fake image." Optional: "[] I would like to talk to the counselor privately."

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** "Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing."
- "This is not your fault. The person who did this is responsible."
- "I can't keep this secret. I need to bring in people who can help, and I will tell you who."
- **Do not say:** "Why did you let them?" or "Are you sure?"
- "I won't tell anyone."
- "Let me see."

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away; follow your school policy and your state's reporting law (NCMEC CyberTipline for online cases). Never view, copy or forward an image.